

Fabric Analyst in a Day (8hrs | 9:00 – 5:00pm (ET))

Build an end-to-end analytics solution in Microsoft Fabric - hands on.

Overview

This one day, instructor led workshop is designed for Power BI data analysts and data professionals who want to accelerate real world analytics in Microsoft Fabric. You'll learn how Fabric unifies data engineering, data warehousing, and BI in a single SaaS experience—and then you'll practice those skills through guided labs that take you from raw data to actionable insights.

What you'll learn

Morning — Foundations & Setup

- **Welcome, goals, and class flow**: Understand the day's objectives and how demos and labs reinforce each concept.
- **Introducing Microsoft Fabric**: Why a unified analytics platform matters; core workloads; how Fabric reshapes the analyst workflow for speed and scale.
- **OneLake fundamentals**: The "OneDrive for data"—shortcuts/virtualization and the one-copy data model to reduce duplication and complexity.
- **Getting hands-on**: Kick off initial labs to orient yourself to workspaces, the Lakehouse, and connectors.

Afternoon — Build, Model, Visualize

- **Data integration & engineering**: Use Data Factory (pipelines & dataflows), follow Lakehouse patterns, and apply notebooks for transformation.
- **Data warehousing in Fabric**: Explore the Warehouse, mirroring options (e.g., Snowflake/Azure SQL/Cosmos DB), and built in governance & security.
- **Analytics & BI**: Create Direct Lake semantic models and build reports in Power BI. See forecasting and AI assisted features in action.
- **Real-time & activation (preview/demo)**: Learn Real-Time Intelligence concepts and how Data Activator turns insights into automated actions.

Wrap-up

- **Lab capstone & live Q&A**: Consolidate the day's work, confirm outcomes, and discuss next steps for applying Fabric in your own tenant.
- **Resources & next steps**: Get links, tutorials, and guidance to keep building after class.

Hands on lab experience (what you'll actually do)

1. **Reverse engineer a Power BI solution**
   Explore an existing report and its queries to see how multiple data sources are combined—then plan how you'll rebuild the solution in Fabric.
2. **Stand up your Fabric environment**
   Enable a Fabric trial, create a workspace and Lakehouse, and tour core experiences: Data Factory, Industry Solutions, Real-Time Intelligence, Data Engineering, Data Science, Data Warehouse, and Databases.
3. **Unify external data with OneLake Shortcuts**
   Connect ADLS Gen2 to your Lakehouse via Shortcuts, then use **Visual Query** to build curated Geo, Reseller, Sales, and Product views—without unnecessary data copies.
4. **Ingest multiple sources at scale**
   Use **Dataflow Gen2** to bring SharePoint and Snowflake data into your Lakehouse, then add Shortcuts to Dataverse and another Lakehouse so all required datasets are available in one place.
5. **Operationalize refresh & orchestration**
   Configure scheduled refreshes by updating the Supplier Dataflow (Snowflake) and

build a **Pipeline** with variables, an **Until** loop, and timed retries. (ADLS Shortcuts and Dataverse links require no refresh.)

6. **Model with SQL & build a semantic layer**
   Query Lakehouse data using SQL, visualize results, and craft a semantic model by creating relationships and measures directly in the Fabric service.

7. **Deliver insights with Power BI (Direct Lake)**
   Use **auto create** to jumpstart a report, then build a custom report from a blank canvas. Connect Power BI Desktop to your semantic model and experience **Direct Lake** for near instant updates.